

UNIT 4: HYPOTHETICAL SITUATIONS & CONDITIONALS

GRAMMAR

Grammar: Second & Third Conditional

Second Conditional: UNREAL / HYPOTHETICAL present or future. If + Past Simple, would + base verb.

Examples: If I had more time, I would learn another language. If she lived closer, we would meet more often.

Third Conditional: UNREAL / HYPOTHETICAL PAST (things that did NOT happen). If + Past Perfect, would have + past participle.

Examples: If I had studied harder, I would have passed the exam. If they had left earlier, they would not have missed the flight.

Mixed Conditional: If + Past Perfect, would + base verb. If I had chosen a different career, I would be happier now.

Key tip: NEVER use 'would' in the if-clause. WRONG: If I would have time... RIGHT: If I had time...

Examples:

- *If I were rich, I would travel the world. (2nd - unreal present)*
- *If she had taken the medicine, she would have recovered faster. (3rd - unreal past)*
- *If I had saved more money, I would be able to buy a car now. (mixed)*

VOCABULARY

Word / Phrase	Definition
hypothetical	imagined or assumed, not real
consequence	a result or effect of an action
regret	a feeling of sadness about something that did/didn't happen
speculate	to form ideas without certain evidence
consider	to think carefully about something
opportunity	a chance to do something
outcome	the result of an action or situation
circumstance	a fact or condition related to a situation
alternative	a different choice or option
nevertheless	despite what has just been said; however

READING TEXT

In 2008, financial analyst Marco Rossi faced a critical decision. His company offered voluntary redundancy packages and he chose to stay, believing job security mattered more. Years later, a colleague who left became a successful entrepreneur. Marco often reflects: 'If I had taken the package, I might have started my own business. I would probably have struggled at first, but I could have achieved something extraordinary.'

He also acknowledges: 'If I had left, I would not have met my wife. So perhaps things worked out for the best.'

EXERCISES: MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. What decision did Marco face in 2008?

- A) Whether to start a business.
- B) Whether to take redundancy or stay.
- C) Whether to change careers.
- D) Whether to move abroad.

2. 'If I had taken the package, I might have started my own business.' This is a:

- A) First conditional
- B) Zero conditional
- C) Third conditional
- D) Second conditional

3. Which sentence is grammatically correct?

- A) If I would study, I would pass.
- B) If she had known, she would have helped.
- C) If they will come, we would celebrate.
- D) If he has time, he would have called.

4. If I ____ (be) you, I would apologise.

- A) am
- B) was
- C) were
- D) had been

5. What does 'redundancy package' most likely mean?

- A) A holiday reward.
- B) A financial offer when leaving a job.
- C) A promotion.
- D) A training programme.

Answer Key: Q1: B | Q2: C | Q3: B | Q4: C | Q5: B

WRITING TASK

Write two paragraphs (120-150 words total). Paragraph 1: A past decision using 3rd conditional: 'If I had..., I would have...' Paragraph 2: A hypothetical present using 2nd conditional: 'If I..., I would...'

SPEAKING PRACTICE

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1. Discuss: If you could change one past decision, what would it be and why?
 2. Speculate: If you had been born in a different country, how would your life be different?
 3. Debate: 'If governments had acted sooner on climate change, we would be in a better situation today.'

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